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Cyber Forensics Lab - 8 -Email Forensics

I was unable to complete the assigned lab tasks due to strict OS-level compatibility issues with the mandated proprietary software. The assignment required the use of Windows-native forensic GUI tools—specifically eMailTrackerPro, Paraben's Email Examiner, and Recover My Email. As my primary workstation runs a customized **Arch Linux** environment, I attempted several technical workarounds to execute these applications, all of which ultimately failed.

First, I attempted to run the software through Wine compatibility layers. Despite configuring clean Wine prefixes and manually installing required core Windows dependencies via Winetricks, the software consistently broke, likely due to unsupported Windows API calls:

- **Paraben's Email Examiner:** Failed entirely during the initial setup and initialization phase.
- **Recover My Email:** Installed successfully but immediately segfaulted and crashed upon execution.
- **eMailTrackerPro:** The installer completely hung at 0% and remained unresponsive for over 1 hour

When the compatibility layer proved unviable, I pivoted to setting up a full Windows Virtual Machine using QEMU/KVM.

However, this approach was also unsuccessful. Beyond the massive resource overhead of provisioning a fresh Windows environment, the virtualized graphics drivers caused the interfaces of these specific forensic tools to artifact, freeze, and become entirely unresponsive when loading the .pst database files.

Because these specific proprietary Windows executables cannot reliably function or render in my environment—either through native translation or hardware virtualization—I was unable to perform the required forensic steps and could not complete the assignment as intended.